

7 The matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is given by

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 7 & 11 \\ 0 & 2 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

(a) Find a matrix $\mathbf{P}$ and a diagonal matrix $\mathbf{D}$ such that $\mathbf{A}^6 = \mathbf{P}\mathbf{D}\mathbf{P}^{-1}$. [7]

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(b) Use the characteristic equation of $\mathbf{A}$ to show that

$$\mathbf{A}^6 = a\mathbf{A}^2 + b\mathbf{A} + c\mathbf{I},$$

where a , b and c are integers to be determined. [4]

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